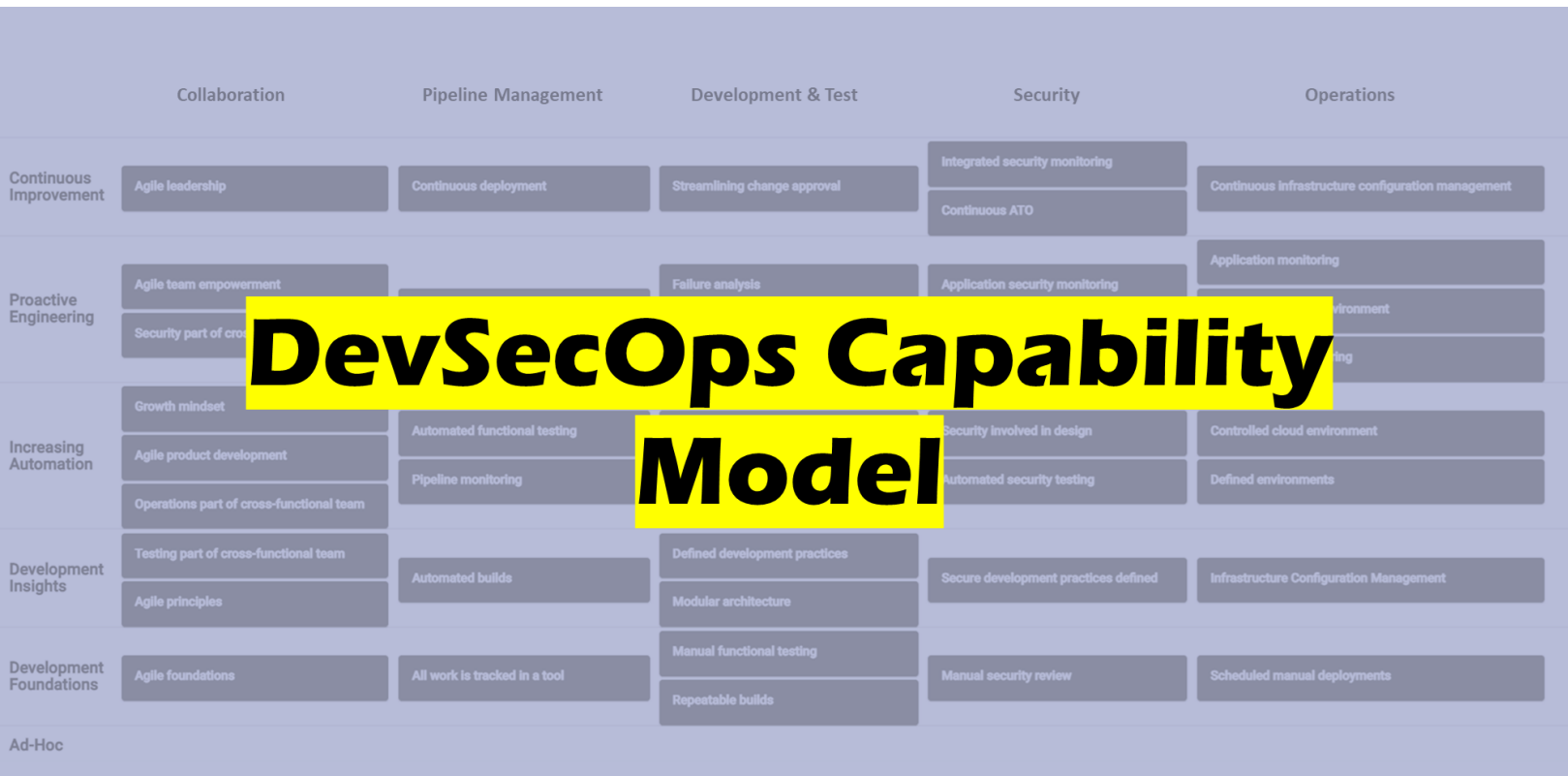




Advance your team's Agile and DevSecOps practices with MITRE's DevSecOps Capability Model (DCaM).

DCaM is a framework that ensures your team addresses all aspects of software engineering with practical, secure development practices. DCaM can be tailored to your environment, and has been implemented by defense, civil and intelligence organizations.

DevSecOps Capability Model (DCaM) Overview

The DevSecOps Capability Model (DCaM) is a tool- and method-agnostic framework for secure development and delivery of software. It guides project teams towards successful implementation of Agile DevSecOps practices that improve speed of delivery, quality, security, and collaboration. DCaM is designed for incremental, targeted improvements, enabling teams to start where the payoff is highest. Project teams adopt these practices to realize benefits such as faster delivery, increased adaptability, improved project quality, strengthened security posture, and improved collaboration.

A product team can use DCaM to:

1. **Assess:** Establish a baseline of DevSecOps maturity via a survey.
2. **Decide:** Decide practices to augment based on targets.
3. **Plan:** Draft an adoption plan based on business needs, identified areas for improvement.
4. **Educate:** Explore and learn what each practice entails and how related practices are connected.
5. **Iterate:** Reassess and refine as project team capabilities grow.

“DevOps benefits all of us in the technology value stream, whether we are Dev, Ops, QA, Infosec, Product Owners, or customers... It enables teams to work together to survive, learn, thrive, delight our customers, and help our organization succeed..”

Gene Kim, The DevOps Handbook: How to Create World-Class Agility, Reliability, & Security in Technology Organizations

How DCaM Works

DCaM defines over 90 capabilities that describe behaviors and practices for maturing DevSecOps practices. High-level capabilities group related capabilities and provide stakeholders an overview of key behaviors. Capabilities are interconnected; prerequisites show how the capabilities build on each other.

- Capability prerequisites provide a ready-made plan to mature towards target practices.
- Each capability includes functional roles, prerequisites, and associated survey questions to assess whether the capability is met.

DCaM Domains

DCaM organizes capabilities into five domains.

- **Collaboration:** How stakeholders and teams work together to plan, build, and release software. Collaboration includes communication, feedback loops, and cross-functional roles within teams.
- **Development and Test:** Engineering practices that produce repeatable results and ensure quality software; growing from manual, inconsistent practices to comprehensive automated practices.
- **Pipelines:** How project teams build, verify, release, and deploy changes; growing from ad hoc scripts to standardized, versioned, and policy-governed CI/CD pipelines for reproducibility.
- **Security:** How project teams integrate security throughout the development process; growing from reactive scans to continuous, automated security integrated throughout.
- **Operations:** Practices that evolve from manual releases and basic monitoring to automated, reliable operations with production-monitoring, alerting, incident response and recovery.

Capability Levels

DCaM defines capability levels to measure project team behaviors and practices. DCaM allows for "spikey" maturity –different maturity levels across the domains – so project teams target needed improvements without feeling pressure to "achieve a particular level".

- **Level 0 – Ad Hoc:** No shared version control, limited Agile practices. Communication is ad-hoc.
- **Level 1 – Development Foundations:** Shared codebase in version control, clear application structure, and a repeatable build. Security and Operations are not integrated.
- **Level 2 – Development Insights:** Well-defined product developed using Agile practices. Testing is an integral part of development. Security and Operations work closely with the team.
- **Level 3 – Increasing Automation:** Defined deployment environments, integrated operations, and comprehensive automated tests that ensure quality.
- **Level 4 – Proactive Engineering:** Increased automation. Security and Operations are fully integrated. Teams monitor environment and failures to continuously improve.
- **Level 5 – Continuous Improvement:** Feedback and metrics are used to optimize how changes flow from development to production.

Getting Started

- Schedule a 30-120 minute cross-functional team assessment to establish a baseline.
- Agree on target outcomes, select target capabilities and create an adoption plan.

Use DCaM as a shared map to align leadership, stakeholders, development, operations, and security on an outcome-driven path to faster, safer delivery.

For information about MITRE's DCAM expertise and capabilities, contact dcam@groups.mitre.org

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